

LESSON FOURTEEN
TOPIC: UNFORGIVENESS
TEXT: Matthew 18:21-35

MEMORY VERSE: Matthew 18:35

This is how my heavenly Father will treat each of you unless you forgive your brother or sister from your heart.

CENTRAL TRUTH: Unforgiveness can trap you in your past and becomes a source of limitation.

INTRODUCTION

It is important to recognize that confession and repentance facilitate the process of forgiveness. Forgiveness entails our decision to refrain from fixating on past grievances. It also signifies our choice not to harbor resentment towards those who have wronged us. Unforgiveness opens a door for the enemy to influence our lives, resulting in deeper spiritual and emotional entrapment. Ephesians 4:27 "... do not give the devil a foothold..."

LESSON OUTLINE

1. Seventy times seven: Matthew 18:21-22

The phrase seventy times seven indicates that there is no cap on the number of times we should extend forgiveness to others. By the time you have forgiven someone 490 times, you have cultivated a habit of perpetual forgiveness. This suggests that forgiveness is boundless. We ought to regard them as brothers - Matthew 18:15,21.

2. Do unto others: Matthew 18:23-28,
If we apply the principle found in Matthew 6:12, 14, can we genuinely expect to receive forgiveness from God? Given that God has absolved us of our significant debts, sins, and errors, we must strive to forgive others to the best of our ability. On the cross, it was not merely the Roman soldiers who inflicted pain on Jesus; it was our sins. We are indebted to forgive because we have been forgiven.

3. Rebuke is not unforgiveness: Matthew 18:31-34
Correction or discipline does not equate to a lack of forgiveness. Christians should be the least likely to take offense. When we face rebuke, we should remember that it is for our benefit - Proverbs 27:5. Indeed, rebuke can serve a positive purpose, especially when it is aimed at correction and growth rather than malice. In another context, we may receive discipline from God or our leaders even after being forgiven, and we should not resist it. Hebrews 12:6-8

QUESTION

1. Should I forgive someone who refuses to repent or seek forgiveness?

CONCLUSION:

Unforgiveness is a spiritual ailment that adversely affects individuals. We are commanded to forgive.